

Wander 1: Thursday afternoon 1/30/25

"Wandering" is exploring a place (a city, a village, a stretch of nature) without normal directions, and without a plan to go somewhere in particular.

Often a wander will follow a set of rules for how to explore.

This is based on practices originally from SI (situationists) and Debord, but with many many other schools, permutations and traditions

INTRODUCTION

One of my new years resolutions (lame) was to wander once a month for the year. It's something I used to do a lot, and have done so somewhat less since moving to New York. Wandering is one of my favorite things to do on earth. Having said that, Wandering is a practice not a single event, and part of the practice is that sometimes wanders are great, sometimes they are shitty, etc. etc. - having expectations about the outcome of the thing really misses the whole idea which is just setting

aside time to be immersed in a place while walking.

Today's instructions are not my own, they are very commonly used, and they are what was used for my first wander which was in Athens with peers - I felt it would be an appropriate way to begin this series of sorts. The music "Thursday Afternoon" is perfect for this Thursday Afternoon, and is my favorite from eno. Thursday Afternoon has a certain intense hold over me. I can hear it playing in a very specific and cherished memory, and I think it will always bring me back some of that

happiness - I wrote about that moment about in a game called "15 things that happened:

"I'm thinking about a night, walking home late from joe's apartment, listening to brian eno. There was a serenity in that moment, crossing the huge empty road that split my neighborhood from his. I can't relive that feeling, but I can touch the corners of it - If I think about it I start to close my eyes and smile. A time that I felt whole in some way - not in every way, but in some way. What's the use of reminiscing anyway. maybe it helps us not lose that part of us,

that we once knew we had for certain. I don't know if I believe that though. It feels like there are no parts of us, just a fluid person gliding to different styles of existing”

THE WANDER

Today's wander is simple
The Rules are as follows:

- No Talking
- Turn your phone to silent, don't open it
- The wander will last exactly 1 hour, which is the length of "Thursday Afternoon" by brian

eno which we will also listen to together

- watch for cars, and signal to others for cars etc.
- There is one leader of the wander at a time, everyone else follows this person
- The leader of the wander walks where they feel like. We are not collectively trying to reach any destination, or go to any place. The leader walks wherever their curiosity brings them. There are no rules or limits about where the leader can or can't go
- When the leader feels they have come to a natural stopping point, whatever that means to them,

they stop, turn around and raise their hand. Another member of the group then raises their own hand, and is now the leader of the group

- Generally, who is leader will change many times during a wander, but the wander is presented without oversight or mediation - as soon as it begins all participants are simply participants

**On wandering: - too much to say.
In Short, observe that around you
as fully as possible.**

Think of your eyes like a camera.

This moment a scene in a film

*Every stretch of the environment
purposefully emphasized by an invisible
director.*

Placed before you to be studied.

*See how these scenes have colors, and
forms, and sounds.*

*you are a keen observer
passing through a world worth watching
Beautiful, stark, chaotic, funny, still,
surreal,*

*lonely, romantic, absurd,
However it may be.*